# Four steps for a safe disagreement

Use this routine only for the made-up, mild scenes. Different views are allowed. No one has to give in to keep peace.

### 1 Pause and check safety

Stop the talk for a moment. Use a familiar calm choice or ask for an agreed pause. If anyone feels unsafe, stop and get a trusted adult.

### 2 Say one thing calmly

Use I feel ... when ... . I would like ... . Keep to the task and a clear request. No blame, insults or raised voices.

### 3 Listen and check

Let the other person respond in their usual way. Check what they mean. Each person can want something different.

### 4 Agree a next step or ask for help

Choose a fair, safe plan that both can accept. If they cannot agree, ask a trusted adult. They may use an agreed pause and check with staff before a safe return.

### Safety first

If unsafe or unsure, stop and tell a trusted adult or school staff. The routine is not for harm or pressure. Staff can use the safeguarding lead. You do not have to solve harm yourself.

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# Two made up disagreements

### B The shared pencil

Two invented learners want to use the same colour pencil for a poster. Both need a short turn. Each wants to go first.

### A line to try

I feel cross when I do not know whose turn is next. I would like us to agree a turn.

### A next step to think about

They could agree short turns and a swap cue, or ask staff to help plan turns.

### C The order of two tasks

Two invented learners plan a small display. One wants to place the cards first. The other wants to choose the heading first. Both tasks need doing.

### A line to try

I feel stuck when we have two plans. I would like us to choose the first step together.

### A next step to think about

They could hear each reason and agree an order, or take an agreed supervised pause and return with staff help.

### Your two practice turns

Use both B and C in the format you choose. A willing pair or staff partner can help. Point, choose a line, type or use your usual aid. No touch or raised voices. Pass or use the agreed pause if needed.

### Visible model A

One learner says I would like a turn next. The other explains they need one short turn. They listen and agree to swap after that turn. They can ask staff for a fair plan if they do not agree.

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# Calm lines and an agreed pause

### An I statement

I feel ... when ... . I would like ... .
Keep the words about the task and a clear request. No blame or insults.

### Clear requests

I would like a turn next.
I would like us to choose the first step.
Can you tell me what you mean?

### A pause line

I need a pause. Can we return with staff help?

### A safe pause and return

Staff agree the supervised place, adult help and check-back. Do not walk away alone. Staff check that return is safe and useful. A learner does not have to return to harm or agree to something unsafe. More adult help can be the next step.

### Help in private

Can we talk in private? I need help with a disagreement. Use words, a note, HELP or your usual aid. If one adult is busy or help is not enough, ask another trusted adult. For urgent safety concerns, get adult help at once.

If you keep a personal line card, keep it private. No real argument or name is needed. Leave blank, use the story or pass. Do not hand in a private card.

Staff: do not collect, photograph, display or compare a private card. Any disclosure goes to the safeguarding lead through school procedure. Support a pupil who cannot identify an adult; do not press.

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# Aids for the first tasks

Keep the words, starter and model. Use your usual aids. Plan in any language.

### Starter

Words: view · want · safe · listen

Start: A disagreement can mean…

Model: People want a different first step.

### Four step model

Words: pause · say · listen · plan

Start: First… Then…

Model: Pause, say a clear request, listen and choose a safe next step.

### Private hinge

Words: fair · choice · help · unsafe

Start: They could… because…

Model: Ask staff if they cannot agree.

### Scene B

Words: turn · pencil · ask · swap

Start: I would like…

Model: I would like us to agree whose turn is next.

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# Aids for practice and review

### Scene C

Words: order · reason · pause · return

Start: I feel… when… I would like…

Model: I feel stuck when we have two plans. I would like a first step.

### Review

Words: check · listen · next step

Start: My next step…

Model: Add a way to check the other person's view.

### Private exit

Words: trusted adult · safe · help

Start: If the talk is unsafe…

Model: Stop and ask a trusted adult for help.

### Two formats same checks

Use the four steps for both made-up scenes. Give a calm I statement, show listening and suggest a fair next step. Show how to use an agreed pause or ask an adult. Both scenes have a practice turn. A pass or another mode is valid. Choose map/list or script/note. Both cover both scenes. Use a book, Type instead, an aid or exact scribe.

### A quiet pause

Use the pause signal agreed with staff. An adult supports the familiar supervised route. No public reason is needed. Do not leave alone. Return with support if safe, use a calm task or catch up privately.

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